

PROSPER AWUNI

Threat Detection Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel and KQL | MITRE ATT&CK and Azure Cloud Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and experienced Threat Detection Engineer with over five years of hands-on expertise in Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender tools, and Azure cloud security. I design and maintain high-quality detection content mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, leveraging attacker tactics, techniques and procedures (TTP) knowledge to build detection logic that surfaces real threats rather than generating noise. I have strong experience working with Azure cloud logging and telemetry, correlating signals across endpoint, identity, and cloud to improve detection coverage. I am equally skilled at building Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) automation and collaborating with security operations teams to operationalise detection content at scale, and I bring a first-principles approach to detection engineering grounded in a deep understanding of attacker behaviour.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Threat Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL analytics rules, detection-as-code, workbooks, data connectors), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), attacker TTP-based detection, detection lifecycle management
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** Advanced KQL for threat detection, behavioural analytics, anomaly detection, and threat hunting across identity, endpoint, and cloud log sources
- **Microsoft Defender Tools:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR), Defender for Cloud Apps
- **Azure Cloud Security and Logging:** Azure Monitor, Log Analytics workspace management, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory) sign-in and audit logging, Azure Sentinel data connector configuration
- **MITRE ATT&CK:** Framework-aligned detection development, TTP mapping and coverage analysis, threat intelligence integration for detection improvement
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks (Logic Apps), PowerShell automation, SOAR orchestration, automated alert enrichment and response
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Prevent, Insight and Discover across large-scale enterprise deployments
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, Tier 3 triage and response, post-incident review
- **Identity and Access Security:** Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera breach and attack simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Lead threat detection engineering in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, authoring advanced KQL analytics rules that surface attacker TTPs across identity, endpoint, and cloud attack surfaces.
- Apply MITRE ATT&CK framework knowledge to build coverage-mapped detection content, closing gaps in detection logic across credential access, lateral movement, persistence, and exfiltration techniques.
- Leverage Azure cloud logging and Microsoft Entra ID telemetry in KQL queries to detect anomalous sign-in behaviour, privilege escalation, and identity-based attacks across the cloud estate.

- Work extensively with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender, correlating XDR signals to create high-fidelity alerts with minimal false-positive noise.
- Build and maintain SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert enrichment, tier-one response, and cross-tool orchestration, reducing analyst toil and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Conduct intelligence-led threat hunting campaigns using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying attacker footholds before they escalate to material incidents.
- Lead Tier 3 incident response in line with NIST 800-61, owning case management from initial detection through containment, eradication, and structured post-incident review.
- Manage vulnerability assessment programmes using Pentra BAS and Tenable.io, using findings to identify detection gaps and improve defensive coverage.

University of the Arts London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Designed and developed KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel targeting credential attacks, data exfiltration, anomalous administrative activity, and lateral movement, all mapped to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs.
- Configured and managed Microsoft Sentinel data connectors, Log Analytics workspaces, and Azure cloud logging to ensure comprehensive telemetry coverage across the environment.
- Deployed and operationalised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across an 8,000-user estate, establishing detection policies, exclusion management, and response workflows.
- Administered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Defender for Identity, managing policies, investigating alerts, and using advanced hunting queries to extend detection beyond built-in rules.
- Built SOAR automation using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel playbooks to automate enrichment, indicator ingestion, and response actions for high-volume alert types.
- Conducted regular threat hunting investigations using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying attacker activity that evaded rule-based detection.
- Maintained Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA policies, using Azure sign-in and audit logs to detect and respond to identity-based threats.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed security monitoring and alert triage within a cloud-first SaaS environment, maintaining endpoint protection, SIEM alerting, and identity access controls.
- Configured Check Point Harmony firewall policies, Mimecast email security, and Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM).
- Responded to security incidents, coordinating containment and remediation across infrastructure and development teams.
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance and risk management activities, contributing to documentation and internal audit processes.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection library covering the MITRE ATT&CK framework, with coverage across credential access, lateral movement, persistence, and data exfiltration techniques, closing measurable gaps in the detection matrix.
- Developed advanced KQL analytics leveraging Azure cloud logging and Microsoft Entra ID telemetry to detect identity-based attacks, anomalous sign-in patterns, and privileged account misuse with high fidelity.
- Deployed and operationalised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM across an 8,000-user estate, establishing detection engineering and threat hunting capability that significantly improved attacker dwell time metrics.
- Built a SOAR playbook library automating enrichment and response for the highest-volume alert types in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing analyst workload and accelerating response times.
- Identified previously unknown attacker footholds through structured threat hunting campaigns using KQL and MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, enabling containment before material impact.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering

- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)